

Assignment No. 8

Environment Setup Guide · PHP · Composer · Laravel · Node.js

01 Postman — Installation

1	Open Command Prompt and run <code>php -v</code> to check whether PHP is already installed.
2	Navigate to the XAMPP/php folder on your machine.
3	Copy the full folder path from the address bar.
4	Open Environment Variables (System Properties → Advanced) and click <i>New</i> under System Variables.
5	Paste the copied path into the variable value field and click OK .
6	Reopen Command Prompt and run <code>php -v</code> again — the PHP version should now appear.
7	If the version still does not appear, repeat steps 2 – 6.

02 Composer — PHP Dependency Manager

1	Search for Composer PHP in your browser and open the official site.
2	Click the Download button to get the installer.
3	Once downloaded, open the installer file.
4	Accept any permission prompts that appear.
5	Follow the wizard — click Next through each screen, then Finish .
6	Verify the installation by running <code>composer -v</code> in Command Prompt.
7	If no output appears, repeat the installation steps from step 2.

03 Laravel — Framework Installation

1	Visit the official Laravel website .
2	Locate and copy the global install command: <code>composer global require laravel/installer</code> .
3	Open Command Prompt, paste the command, and press Enter.
4	Create a new folder on your Desktop — for example, my_app .
5	Open File Explorer and navigate inside the <i>my_app</i> folder.
6	Launch Command Prompt from that folder path (type <code>cmd</code> in the address bar).
7	Run <code>laravel new my_app</code> to scaffold the project.

04 Node.js — Runtime Installation

1	Go to the official Node.js website (nodejs.org).
2	Click the recommended Download button for your OS.
3	Run the downloaded installer and accept any permission prompts.
4	Click Next through the setup wizard, then Finish .
5	Confirm the installation by running <code>node -v</code> and <code>npm -v</code> in Command Prompt.
6	If either command returns nothing, reinstall and repeat the steps above.

05 Configuring php.ini

1	Open the php.ini file in VS Code (located inside your XAMPP/php directory).
2	Press Ctrl + F and search for <code>extension=zip</code> (around line 962).
3	Remove the semicolon (;) at the beginning of that line to uncomment it.
4	Save the file, then open Command Prompt and run <code>php -m</code> .
5	Confirm that <i>zip</i> appears in the module list. If not, verify you are using PHP 8.2 (not 8.0) and repeat.

■ Make sure your active PHP version is 8.2. The zip extension path differs between versions.

06 Creating a New Laravel Project

1	Open XAMPP's htdocs folder in Command Prompt.
2	Run <code>laravel new my_app</code> and respond to the setup prompts as follows:
3	Starter kit → None
4	Testing framework → 0 (PHPUnit)
5	AI assistant coding → No
6	Database → MySQL
7	Run default database migrations → Yes
8	Ignore npm install script → Yes
9	Once the project is created, run: <code>cd my_app</code> followed by <code>composer run dev</code> .
10	Open your browser and visit <code>localhost : 8000</code> to confirm the app is running.

■ To reopen an existing project: navigate to `htdocs/my_app` in cmd and simply run '`composer run dev`'.